Delivery Approach

Predictive, agile or hybrid? Score the project's culture, team and work, then choose an approach for each part.

Run a Project · Inspired by the suitability filter in the Agile Practice Guide (PMI® and Agile Alliance®) · Tailoring

PROJECT _____

DATE _____

1 Suitability Check

CIRCLE ONE SCORE PER ROW · DISCUSS WHERE YOU DISAGREE

	LEANS AGILE (1)	SCORE	LEANS PREDICTIVE (5)
CULTURE			
Support for iterative working	Sponsors and team want it	1 2 3 4 5	Little support for it
Trust in the team	Team decides how to work	1 2 3 4 5	Decisions made above the team
Speed of decisions	Fast, close to the work	1 2 3 4 5	Slow, many approvals
TEAM			
Team size and stability	Small and stable	1 2 3 4 5	Large or often changing
Experience	Used to iterative delivery	1 2 3 4 5	New to it
Access to the customer	Available every week	1 2 3 4 5	Rarely available
PROJECT			
Certainty of requirements	Will change as we learn	1 2 3 4 5	Stable and known up front
Cost of changing later	Cheap to change	1 2 3 4 5	Costly once built
Delivering in pieces	Useful in small pieces	1 2 3 4 5	Only useful when complete
Regulation and sign-off	Light	1 2 3 4 5	Heavy, formal sign-offs

Total (10–50): _____ *Look at the pattern, not just the total: one high score can need its own approach.*

2 Reading the Score

A RULE OF THUMB, NOT A VERDICT

Agile — Mostly 1s and 2s · total about 10-20

Deliver in short iterations, with the customer close by. Plan a little, often.

Hybrid — A mix · total about 21-35

Iterate where learning matters, and plan up front where change is costly. Agree how the parts meet.

Predictive — Mostly 4s and 5s · total about 36-50

Plan and design up front, with formal change control. Still look for chances to get feedback early.

Most organisations end up hybrid. That's fine: the aim is the right approach for each part of the work.

3 Work Streams

THE APPROACH CAN DIFFER BY PART

PART OF THE WORK	APPROACH	WHY	OWNER

4 How the Parts Connect

WHERE AGILE AND PREDICTIVE WORK MEET

Shared milestones: _____

Gates, and the evidence that answers them: _____

Reporting rhythm: _____

Hand-offs and dependencies between parts: _____

Revisit the approach on: _____

"Which parts of this work will we only understand by doing them?"

"Where is change cheap, and where is it expensive?"

© 2026 Eric Parker · CC BY 4.0 · eparker71.github.io/agile-ways-of-working

PMI® is a registered trademark of Project Management Institute, Inc. · Run a Project